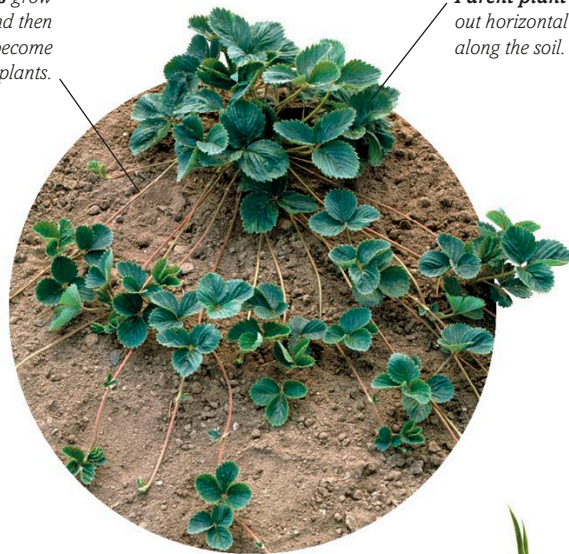




Spider plant

These stems grow roots and then leaves to become independent plants.



Strawberry

Parent plant sends out horizontal stems along the soil.

New bamboo shoots can grow up to 35 in (90 cm) in a day.

STEM RUNNERS

The strawberry plant produces long stems called runners that run along or just under the soil. New strawberry plants grow at the knots, or nodes, on the runners, quickly colonizing an area with good soil.

Runners lay down roots before new plants can grow.

Parent plant New plant

Plantlets grow on dangling stems.

New shoots grow from marks called "eyes."

Sweet potato

Fleshy root tubers are popular starchy foods.

Underground stems spread quickly, sending up new shoots.



Bamboo

organs called tubers. If harsh weather kills off their leaves, new plants can regrow from the starchy tuber, using it for food. **Spider plants** grow new leaves at the tips of their hanging flower stems, which quickly grow roots when they detect that they

are touching the ground. The **mother of thousands** plant takes this even further, producing tiny plantlets, complete with roots, along the edges of its leaves. These eventually drop off the mother plant and grow around its base.